

# TestAutothon 2026

**CODE. AUTOMATE. DOMINATE.**

THE ULTIMATE HACKATHON FOR **AUTOMATION TESTING EXPERTS** IS BACK



**DAY 1**

**9 – Sep – 2026 (Wednesday)**



The Chancery Pavilion, Residency Road, Bengaluru



**DAY 2**

**10 – Sep – 2026 (Thursday)**



Radisson Blu, Marthahalli, Bengaluru

**ONE Challenge. ENDLESS Possibilities.**

## ABOUT THE EVENT

# Event Overview

### STeP-IN Forum

Software Test Practitioners, India — APAC's largest software testing forum, bringing together the community that builds quality into every release.

#### WHAT WE RUN

Conferences

Summits

Evening Tech Talks (ETT)

Webinars

Workshops

CxO RoundTables

TestAutothons

Community Building & Engagement

### TestAutothon 2026

A high-energy, two-day automation testing hackathon where QA minds battle it out across two competitive challenge tracks.

2

EVENT DAYS

5 Hrs

TO BUILD & TEST

2

CHALLENGE TRACKS

5

MAX TEAM SIZE

## THE JOURNEY

# How the Challenge Works



**01**

### Briefing

Welcome address, jury introductions and problem statement briefing on Day 1 morning.

**02**

### Build

Teams work on Automation Quest and Bug Quest solutions in parallel.

**03**

### Evaluate

Jury members evaluate every team's submissions on Day 1 afternoon.

**04**

### Shortlist

Top 8 teams are announced at the close of Day 1.

**05**

### Present & Win

Shortlisted teams present on Day 2; winners are announced by the Jury.

## SCHEDULE

# Day 1 & Day 2 Schedule

### DAY 1 — WED, 9 SEP 2026

*Hotel Chancery Pavilion, Residency Road*

- **9:00a – 10:00a**  
Welcome Address, Jury Introductions & Problem Statement Briefing
- **10:00a – 3:00p**  
Working on Solutions by Contestants (Tea / Coffee / Lunch included)
- **3:00p – 5:00p**  
Evaluation by Jury Members
- **5:00p – 5:30p**  
Jury Deliberations & Fun Game for Participants
- **5:30p – 5:45p**  
Announcement of 8 Shortlisted Teams & Closing Remarks

### DAY 2 — THU, 10 SEP 2026

*Radisson Blu, Marthahalli*

- **8:00a**  
Shortlisted teams to be present at the venue
- **8:30a – 1:00p**  
Shortlisted Team Presentations — max. 30 minutes per team
- **Throughout**  
Only the Jury Panel is the audience during presentations
- **Ongoing**  
Remaining teams continue in the Summit Proceedings
- **5:30p**  
Winner & Runner-up teams announced by the Jury

*Team leads of shortlisted teams stay in continuous touch with Pinky Tyagi for presentation sequencing.*

## COMPETE

# Challenge Tracks



## Automation Quest

Judged by the STeP-IN Jury

Automation frameworks built by every team are evaluated by the STeP-IN judging panel.

- Two winning teams
- Top 8 teams selected on Day 1
- Advance to Day 2 evaluation round



## Bug Quest

Judged by the Platform Hosting Team

Test strategies and bug reports submitted by every team are evaluated by the Platform Hosting team.

- Three winning teams
- Evaluated on strategy & reports
- Runs alongside Automation Quest

*Both tracks run in parallel across the same two days — see Automation Quest and Bug Quest for full details.*

## TRACK 01 — AUTOMATION QUEST

# Automation Quest



### Judged by the STeP-IN Jury

The Automation Quest will have two winning teams. Automation frameworks built during the contest are evaluated by the STeP-IN judging panel.

#### PROGRESSION

- The top eight teams are selected by the judges on Day 1
- Selected teams are invited to the next evaluation round on Day 2



WINNER

**₹1,00,000**



RUNNER-UP

**₹70,000**

## TRACK 02 — BUG QUEST

# Bug Quest



### Judged by the Platform Hosting Team

The Bug Quest will have three winning teams. Test strategies and bug reports submitted by every team are evaluated by the Platform Hosting team.

#### WHAT'S EVALUATED

- Depth and clarity of the test strategy document
- Quality, accuracy and impact of the bug reports filed



WINNER

**₹15,000**



RUNNER-UP

**₹12,500**



2ND RUNNER-UP

**₹10,000**

## SUBMIT

# Required Deliverables

1

## Automation Framework & Execution Report



Submit via a GitHub repository link. Teams are free to use any automation framework or programming language.

### Naming convention:

```
TeamName-TestAutothon26-AutomationFramework
```

*Using a proprietary framework that cannot be uploaded to GitHub? Inform the judges/organizers at the start of the contest.*

2

## Test Strategy Document & Bug Report



Upload to your team's folder in the Google Drive URL shared during the event.

### Naming convention:

```
TeamName_TestAutothon26_TestStrategy
TeamName_TestAutothon26_BugReport
```

*Format: Word, PDF or Excel.*



**Both submissions are mandatory. Late or incomplete submissions may not be considered for evaluation.**



## OPPORTUNITY

# Double-Win Opportunity

Teams should mandatorily participate in both tracks and are eligible to win prizes in the Automation Quest and the Bug Quest separately.

### Automation Quest

Winner **₹1,00,000**

Runner-up **₹70,000**

### Bug Quest

Winner **₹15,000**

Runner-up **₹12,500**

Second Runner-up **₹10,000**

**COMBINED PRIZE POOL ACROSS BOTH TRACKS**

**₹2,07,500+**

## GAME PLAN

# General Challenge Instructions

- **Contest would be around Web and Mobile (Android) Automation**
- **Every team faces two challenges:** build a robust automation framework for the application under test, and create a comprehensive test strategy that identifies meaningful product defects.

Teams may divide into smaller groups and work on both challenges in parallel. How each team organizes itself and allocates time is entirely up to the team.

## RECOMMENDED TIME SPLIT — WITHIN THE TOTAL 5 HOURS GIVEN TO SOLVE

**AUTOMATION QUEST — 3 HOURS**

**BUG QUEST — 2 HOURS**

*This is only a recommendation — teams are free to follow any strategy they believe will produce the strongest submission.*

## AI-POWERED

# Use of AI

The use of AI is strongly encouraged throughout TestAutothon. Teams should use AI wherever it can meaningfully accelerate planning, development, execution, analysis, or reporting.



Test strategy generation & improvement



Test scenario & edge-case identification



Automation framework design



Automation code generation & refactoring



Test data creation



Test failure diagnosis



Self-healing automation capabilities



Accessibility, security, performance & visual analysis



Test result summarization



Dashboards & execution insights



Defect analysis & business-impact estimation



Bug description & repro-step improvement



Product recommendations

*AI usage alone will not guarantee additional points — judges evaluate how appropriately, effectively, and responsibly AI has been incorporated.*

## TRANSPARENCY

# AI Disclosure & Responsible Use

Teams must understand, review, validate, and be able to explain all AI-generated work to the judges. Submissions containing unverified or non-functional AI-generated content may lose points.

### TEAMS MUST DISCLOSE TO THE JUDGES

- ✓ AI tools and models used
- ✓ The tasks for which AI was used
- ✓ Important prompts or prompt sequences
- ✓ AI-generated outputs incorporated into the submission
- ✓ How those outputs were reviewed or validated
- ✓ Errors, limitations, or hallucinations identified
- ✓ Time saved or improvements achieved through AI



### SECURITY REMINDER

**Never include passwords, OTPs, personal data, credentials, proprietary information, or other sensitive data in public AI tools or submitted prompts.**

## JUDGING

# Evaluation Criteria

01



### Solve the Damn Problem

Unless the automated workflow works, all meta parameters of evaluation hold no fruit.

02



### Quality of Solution

This is where the “how well” part of the implementation is evaluated.

03



### Quality of Team Work

Overall attitude of the team within themselves and with regards to other contestants.

04



### AI Innovation & Impact

How effectively the team uses AI to make the solution smarter, more efficient, and meaningfully better than a conventional approach.



### THE X-FACTOR

The final differentiator — when a contestant breaks all myths of evaluation and surprises the Jury with something completely out of the box.

## THE JUDGES

# Jury Panel

The Jury Panel, selected by STeP-IN Forum, comprises industry experts coming from a wide variety of contexts, layers and roles.



### Industry Experts

Drawn from a wide variety of contexts, layers and roles across the testing industry.



### Fair & Neutral

The Jury will be fair and neutral in every decision made during the contest.



### Final Decision

The Jury's decision on all evaluations and rankings will be final.

COME PREPARED

# What Contestants Should Bring



## A Winning Spirit

Bring your energy, focus and competitive edge.



## Laptops

Your primary machine to build and test on.



## Tools & Frameworks

Any tools or frameworks you plan to use during the contest.



## Internet Dongles

A backup connection in case venue Wi-Fi is unavailable.



## Projector Connectors

Especially if using a Mac for your Day 2 presentation.

## KEY FACTS

# Quick Reminders



### TEAM SIZE

Maximum of 5 engineers



### RESOURCES

All required input files & instructions provided at the start of the challenge



### EVALUATION CRITERIA

Correctness, adherence, clarity, and reproducibility

## TOTAL DURATION BREAK-UP

### DAY 1 — 9 SEP 2026 (WED)

**1 Hr**

Problem Statement Briefing

**5 Hrs**

Working on Solutions

**2 Hrs**

Jury Evaluation

**0.5 Hrs**

Jury Deliberations + Announcement of 8 Shortlisted Teams

### DAY 2 — 10 SEP 2026 (THU)

**5 Hrs**

Jury Evaluation of Shortlisted Teams



## LEGAL

# Protection of Intellectual Property

By submitting STeP-IN Forum (Verity Management Software) TestAutothon Entry or accepting any prize, you represent and warrant the following: **(a)** you will not submit content that is copyrighted, protected by trade secret or otherwise subject to third party intellectual property rights or other proprietary rights, including privacy and publicity rights, unless you are the owner of such rights or have permission from their rightful owner to post the content and to grant STeP-IN Forum (Verity Management Software) TestAutothon all of the rights granted herein; **(b)** you will not publish falsehoods or misrepresentations that could damage STeP-IN Forum (Verity Management Software) TestAutothon, Sponsors, or any third party; **(c)** you will not submit content that is unlawful, obscene, defamatory, libelous, threatening, pornographic, harassing, hateful, racially or ethnically offensive, or encourages conduct that would be considered a criminal offense, give rise to civil liability, violate any law, or is otherwise inappropriate or destructive to STeP-IN Forum (Verity Management Software) or Sponsors' brand image or goodwill; **(d)** you will not post advertisements or solicitations of business; **(e)** STeP-IN Forum (Verity Management Software) TestAutothon will not be obligated to pay any compensation to, or permit any participation by, any third party in connection with the use, reproduction, modification, publication, display or other exploitation of any of the content that you submit; and **(f)** the content submitted by you does not contain any viruses, Trojan horses, worms or other disabling devices or harmful code.

# Looking Forward to Your Support

in Building the **Testing Community**

testAutothon 2026

## STeP-IN TEAM

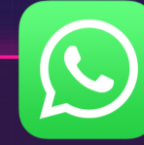
📞 Pinky Tyagi — +91 72598 68993

📞 Anil Nahata — +91 98230 64054

Email: [Conferences@stepinforum.org](mailto:Conferences@stepinforum.org)

[www.testautothon.org](http://www.testautothon.org)

#TestAutothon2026 • #STePINSummit2026



JOIN OUR

## WHATSAPP GROUP



### Scan the QR code

to join our WhatsApp group and stay updated with future events, important announcements, conference information, and community updates.